

## SYNTHESISING SENTENCES

The final sentence of a paragraph should reflect on how the examples you have analysed work together to show a key idea from the essay topic. This is called a *synthesising sentence* because it brings together or synthesises all the examples.

In the table below, the sentences about specific examples have been put in the left column and the concluding sentence in the right. Look through the example below and consider how the synthesising sentence provides a bigger picture analysis than the preceding specific examples:

| Specific examples                                                                                                                                                                                 | Big picture analysis                                                                                 |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <i>Her dad tells her to “go away” and her mother “ignored her”, leading to Coraline feeling both unimportant and that there is nowhere she belongs.</i>                                           | <i>As a consequence of being neglected by the adults, Coraline decides to explore another world.</i> |
| <i>Furthermore, the other adults, like Miss Spink and Miss Forcible don’t even realise her real name is Coraline and not “Caroline”, which adds to Coraline’s feeling of not being cared for.</i> |                                                                                                      |

Now let’s look in more detail at how the synthesising sentence works. There are two parts to this sentence – the concluding phrase and the synthesis:

| Concluding phrase                                         | Big picture analysis using a verb of discovery or analytic verb |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| <i>As a consequence of being neglected by the adults,</i> | <i>Coraline <b>decides</b> to explore another world.</i>        |

The first half of this sentence starts with a concluding phrase, signalling that the writer is about to synthesise the preceding examples. The second part of the sentence has either a verb of discovery or an analytic verb.

That is because these verbs are used for two different reasons:

- A verb of discovery is used to show how a character does something about a key idea.
- An analytic verb is used to write about qualities or skills a character shows about a key idea.



| Concluding phrases      | Verbs of discovery | Analytic verbs |
|-------------------------|--------------------|----------------|
| Consequently,           | decides            | demonstrates   |
| As a consequence of..., | changes            | illustrates    |
| As result,              | realises           | reveals        |
| Therefore,              | becomes            | displays       |
| In response to...,      | finds              | represents     |
| Through her/his...,     | overcomes          | proves         |
|                         | learns             | establishes    |
|                         | realises           |                |
|                         | accepts            |                |

When doing these activities, make sure you apply the **introductory information comma rule**.

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